

Hype Cycle

Purpose

Client Utility - Get Foresight

Hype Cycles provide clients with an overview and graphical depiction of the relative maturity of technologies and innovations in a specific area, offering a simple way to understand and communicate the complex issues related to maturing innovations and their associated benefits. They provide not only a scorecard to separate hype from reality, but also a model that helps enterprises understand the landscape of various technologies, services and business disciplines so they may plan for usage within their organizations.

Although many of Gartner's Hype Cycles are focused on technologies, this methodology can apply to any innovation that evolves and matures over time within enterprises (e.g., DevOps).

In many cases, the Hype Cycles position higher-level trends and ideas such as strategies, standards, management concepts (e.g., enterprise architecture, digital business, agile software development), competencies and capabilities.

What You Need to Know

Provides an overview of the relative maturity of technologies and innovations in a specific area. This is done via two mandatory graphics: the Hype Cycle and the Priority Matrix.

Vendor clients use Hype Cycles to better understand their markets — how specific technologies and innovations impact their product/offerings or the adoption of their products.

Consider publishing a Hype Cycle when:

- Your research area contains many technologies and innovations of interest to a target audience.
- An area generates high client inquiry or press coverage, and our point of view and recommendations are distinctive to what's reported in the public domain.
- A market or research area expands in its level of complexity.

While writing a Hype Cycle, remember:

- The area should be a space that will endure for several years – as will the innovations to be covered – so Gartner can track its progress over time in annual updates.
- Any new Hype Cycle requires the approval of the appropriate KI Leader (KIL) and Chief of Research (CoR), as well as the lead author's Team Manager (TM).

KEY INFORMATION

Research Model:
A&E

Alternatives:
[Innovation Insight](#)

Contextualization Options:
None

BTI Studio:
[Launchpad](#)
[Publishing 2.0 Resources](#)

Good Examples:
[Hype Cycle for Artificial Intelligence, 2025](#)

[Hype Cycle for the Future of Work, 2025](#)

Lifecycle:
[Content Type Life Cycle](#)
[Management Options](#)

External Review:
N/A

For Help:
[AskMethodologies](#)
AskRAStudio@gartner.com
[HC Teams Channel](#)

Hype Cycle

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Hype Cycle

How to Create a Hype Cycle

The following sections provide a guide for each activity, followed by a section on how to write and structure Hype Cycles.

Creating a New Hype Cycle

New Hype Cycles are created within the CPP Planning environment. Perform the following steps to create a new Hype Cycle.

1. Open up [CPP Planning](#)
2. Select the 'New Planning Item' button to open up the modal.

Figure 3. CPP Planning Window

The screenshot displays the Gartner CPP Planning interface. On the left, a sidebar contains a 'Views' section with a list of folders including 'Backtagging', 'My Favorites', 'My Items', 'Agentic AI', 'Amanda Beddingfield', 'Claudia T', 'GenAI', 'Global Talent Labs', 'Hamal Joshi', 'Joel S', 'Knox Huston', 'Markets', 'Multimedia Team', and 'Portfolio Managemen...'. A red box highlights the '+ NEW PLANNING ITEM' button. The main area shows a search bar and a list of results. Overlaid on this is the 'Add Item' modal window. The modal has a title bar with a close button. Below the title bar, there is a legend: '*Required Field | **Indicates Required To Enter Next Phase | See All Fields' with a toggle switch. The form fields include: 'Status' (a dropdown menu with 'Idea' selected), 'Item Id' (a text field), 'Title' (a text field), 'Reviewed by Celia' (a checkbox), 'Summary' (a text area), 'Primary Function \ Role' (a dropdown menu), and 'Primary Key Initiative \ Core Topic(s) \ Client Question(s)' (a text area). At the bottom right of the modal are two buttons: 'Add Another' and 'Add'.

3. From the Add Item modal window, enter the Title and Primary Audience information using the drop downs, including Function, Role, Key Initiative and Agenda (including Core Topics and Client Questions).
4. Continue to scroll down in the modal to add key information.

Hype Cycle

Figure 4. Add Item Modal

*Required Field | **Indicates Required To Enter Next Phase | See All Fields ☐

Primary Key Initiative \ Core Topic(s) \ Client Question(s)

Research Model

Content Type \ Content SubType

Client Interest ☐

Uniqueness ☐

Lead Author

5. Under the CPP Research Model, select “Analysis & Evaluation.”
6. Under Content Type, select “Hype Cycle.”
7. Under How Much of This Is New IP, select “100%.”
8. Add additional metadata as needed, including Target Publish Date, Co-authors, Client Interest and Uniqueness.

To promote a Hype Cycle to Draft phase, it must be approved by the KI Leader and the author’s Team Manager.

Creating a UNI of an Existing Hype Cycle

Any previously published Hype Cycle can be reused with the UNI function. To UNI a Hype Cycle, find the item you wish to UNI in Workspace and open the item info page or Go to CPP Planning, find the item you wish to UNI and click on it to open its Item flyout.

In Workspace, from the Actions menu, select “Update”. You will be prompted to complete the UNI for Hype Cycle in CPP Planning.

Hype Cycle

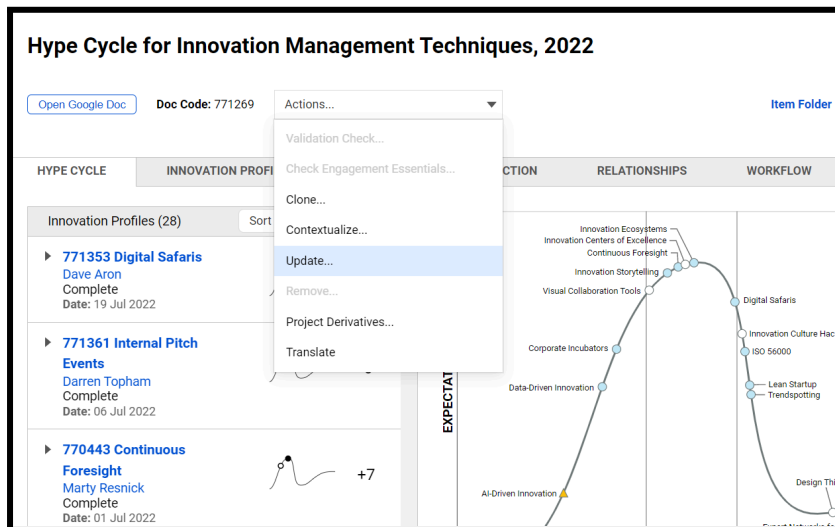


Figure 5. UNI Relationship Window

Update

This Functionality Has Moved to CPP Planning

UNI: A new iteration of a research piece that, when published on gartner.com, automatically archives the prior version. Archived content appears lower in search results and redirects readers to the UNI.

- **Use:** To update research with new data, insights or perspectives, update any evaluative content
- **Do not use:** To correct errors in a published piece

Light Update: A limited update to a published research piece to enhance its position and extend its active window. Available for specific content types only. "Suggesting" mode must be on before changing content.

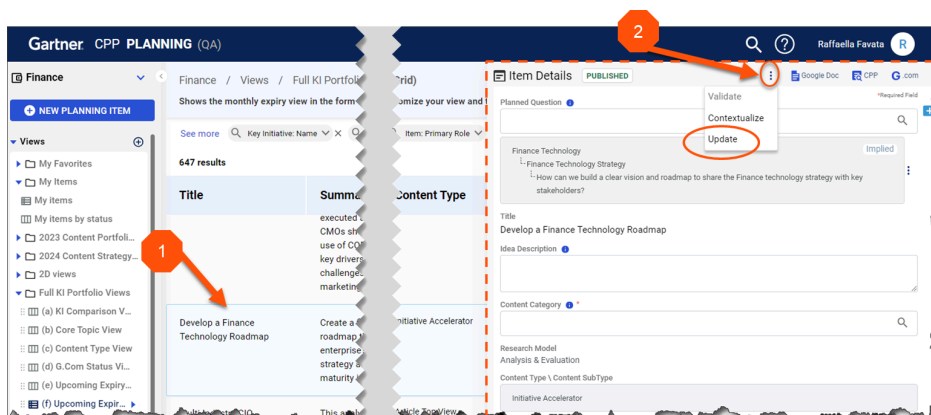
- **Use:** For small, specific changes or enhancements that do not change our position
- **Do not use:** To change our position with new data, insights or perspectives

*This Light Update guidance applies for all regular content; if you are updating content designated as **Evolving Insights**, however, there are no limitations in the scope of the changes allowed (e.g., positional changes are permitted).*

Cancel

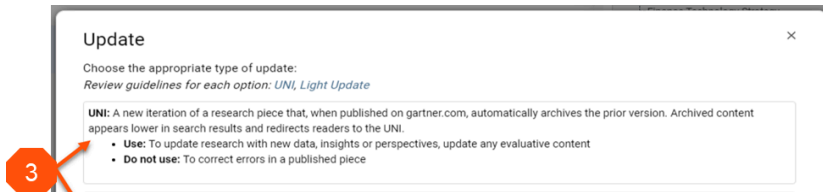
Visit CPP Planning

Through CPP Planning, on the Item flyout click on the 3 dots you will find at the top to open the Actions menu and click on "Update".



In the Modal that opens click to choose the UNI option:

Hype Cycle



Once you have made your selection follow the prompt to complete the new item creation.

Once the UNI is completed, you will need to update mandatory metadata, including Role, Key Initiative, Core Topic and Client Question. To promote a Hype Cycle to Draft phase, it must be approved by the KI Leader and the author's Team Manager. **When the Hype Cycle is promoted to Draft phase, all associated IPs are UNI'd as well.**

How to Write, Structure and Style a Hype Cycle Report

The Section Heading column specifies whether each section is required or optional and indicates whether or not the heading in the CPP canvas will publish on g.com.

[Hype Cycle Quality Checklist](#) - **NEW**

Section Headings	How to Write, Structure and Style It
Title Required	• Format: Hype Cycle for [Area], 20xx • Use "Title" style in this section • Ideal Length: Up to 200 characters (including spaces)
Summary Required	• In 2-3 sentences, convey the challenge, opportunity or situation that your research pertains to, then outline how this innovation could help clients • Write to the approved target role. • Use sentence case in this section, except for when the term is a proper noun or you are using an acronym. • Length: No more than 300 characters (including spaces). HARD LIMIT
Strategic Planning Assumption Optional	• Provide overview predictions on the market or area covered by the Hype Cycle. • Provide forecasts on specific technologies; in such a case, include the SPA in the associated Innovation Profile's "Position and Adoption Speed Justification" or "User Advice" area.
Analysis Required	Comprises the What You Need to Know, The Hype Cycle, The Priority Matrix, Off the Hype Cycle subsections (see row below)
What You Need to Know Required	• Tell a brief story about the Hype Cycle - but avoid "history lessons" - on what readers need to know • Identify the audience; state the challenge; issue a call to action • NEW Describe the current status of the space based on the patterns of the Hype Cycle (e.g. the distribution of innovation profile, lots vs. little action, fast moving vs.

Hype Cycle

	slow changes, major new themes, bald areas, comparisons with last year, future directions, etc.) • This section will appear in the interactive hype cycle • Ideal Length: Up to 150 words
The Hype Cycle Required	Directly beneath the The Hype Cycle section header, describe or define the area or market the Hype Cycle will address. • Identify key trends or drivers that affect the rate of adoption — in particular, note the trends or drivers that affect the area most at the present time. • Highlight fast-moving innovations or failures (e.g., new entrants, fast movers, most hyped, most undervalued, any that will be obsolete before plateau). • Do not use names of Hype Cycle curve positions in the text (e.g., post-trigger 25%). Instead, use natural language such as “climbing the peak...” • Note: this section will not appear on the interactive hype cycle • Ideal Length: Up to 300 words • Optional: When possible, show relationships to other research (e.g., map Innovation Profiles to architectural layers or categories of applications, tie hype levels to numbers of inquiries or survey results). <i>Note: This text appears before the Hype Cycle figure. Although you will be discussing the figure, there is no need to cite “(see Figure 1)”.</i>
The Priority Matrix Required	Directly beneath the The Priority Matrix section header, identify transformative or high-impact technologies that are likely to mature during the next two years. • Describe how your target audience can expedite adoption to gain a competitive advantage. • Explain the impact that the transformational innovations will have, on what roles, and in what time frame. • Ideal Length: Up to 200 words <i>Note: This text appears before the Priority Matrix figure. Although you will be discussing the figure, there is no need to cite “(see Figure 2)”.</i>
Off the Hype Cycle Optional	List Innovation Profiles that were on the previous version of the Hype Cycle, and why they were removed. • Section is optional but encouraged • Cover IPs that are not on the Hype Cycle for various reasons (e.g., fully mature, name changed to xxx, moved to Hype Cycle Y this year, subsumed by xyz), but that clients may wonder about, based on the Hype Cycle’s market or scope. • Format: Bulleted entries or a simple list • Ideal Length: Limit 100 words per IP description

Hype Cycle

On the Rise Required	IPs in this category are placed on the Hype Cycle during the report-creation process. CPP will group them in the report by the order of their position on the Hype Cycle. • HC range: Trigger to Pre-Peak 25% • Maturity Level: Embryonic or Emerging • Time to Plateau: More than 10 years, or 5 to 10 years • Market Penetration as % of Target Audience: Less than 1%, or 1%-5%
At the Peak Required	IPs in this category are placed on the Hype Cycle during the report-creation process. CPP will group them in the report by the order of their position on the Hype Cycle. • HC range: Pre-Peak 20% to Post-Peak 20% • Maturity Level: Emerging or Adolescent • Time to Plateau: More than 10 years, or 5 to 10 years, or 2 to 5 years • Market Penetration as % of Target Audience: 1%-5%, or 5% to 20%
Sliding Into the Trough Required	IPs in this category are placed on the Hype Cycle during the report-creation process. CPP will group them in the report by the order of their position on the Hype Cycle. • HC range: Post-Peak 25% to Post-Trough 15% • Maturity Level: Emerging or Adolescent • Time to Plateau: 5 to 10 years, or 2 to 5 years, or Less than 2 years • Market Penetration as % of Target Audience: 1%-5%, or 5% to 50%
Climbing the Slope Required	IPs in this category are placed on the Hype Cycle during the report-creation process. CPP will group them in the report by the order of their position on the Hype Cycle. • HC range: Post-Trough 20% to Pre-Plateau 25% • Maturity Level: Adolescent or Early Mainstream • Time to Plateau: 2 to 5 years, or less than two years • Market Penetration as % of Target Audience: 5% to 20%, or 20% to 50%
Entering the Plateau Required	IPs in this category are placed on the Hype Cycle during the report-creation process. CPP will group them in the report by the order of their position on the Hype Cycle. • HC range: Pre-Plateau 25% to Plateau • Maturity Level: Early Mainstream or Mature Mainstream (rarely used) • Time to Plateau: Less than two years • Market Penetration as % of Target Audience: 20% to 50%, or more than 50% (rarely used)

Hype Cycle

Appendixes Required	Directly beneath the Appendixes section header, insert the Hype Cycle link from the prior year. When inserting the link include the following description to link: “See the previous Hype Cycle: Hype Cycle for XXX, 2022”
Hype Cycle Phases, Benefit Ratings and Maturity Levels Required	Three populated tables will be included in this section automatically when the canvas first loads: Hype Cycle Phases, Benefit Ratings and Maturity Levels
Acronym Key and Glossary Terms Optional	Include market and technology definitions, if needed. Refer to this link to see Gartner’s standard definitions Glossary
Evidence Optional	Provide the factual basis for your analysis.
Notes Optional	- Use notes to add non-essential detail or context. - Replace the text “Notes” with this format: “Note X: [Title]”

Instructions to Authors

Once you have confirmed approval from the appropriate Chief of Research (CoR), there are two ways to create or update a Hype Cycle:

- New Hype Cycle: Creation of a brand new Hype Cycle.
- Update New Iteration (UNI): Update of the previous year’s version of an existing Hype Cycle.

See [How to Create a Hype Cycle](#) for more.

Understanding the Hype Cycle Document

The three components of a Hype Cycle are:

- [Hype Cycle graphic and Priority Matrix table](#): These graphics appear in both the interactive version of the Hype Cycle and the full Hype Cycle document on gartner.com.
- [Innovation Profiles](#): This text appears in both the interactive version of the Hype Cycle and the full Hype Cycle document.
- [Hype Cycle report content](#): This text appears in the full Hype Cycle document.

Hype Cycle and Priority Matrix Graphics

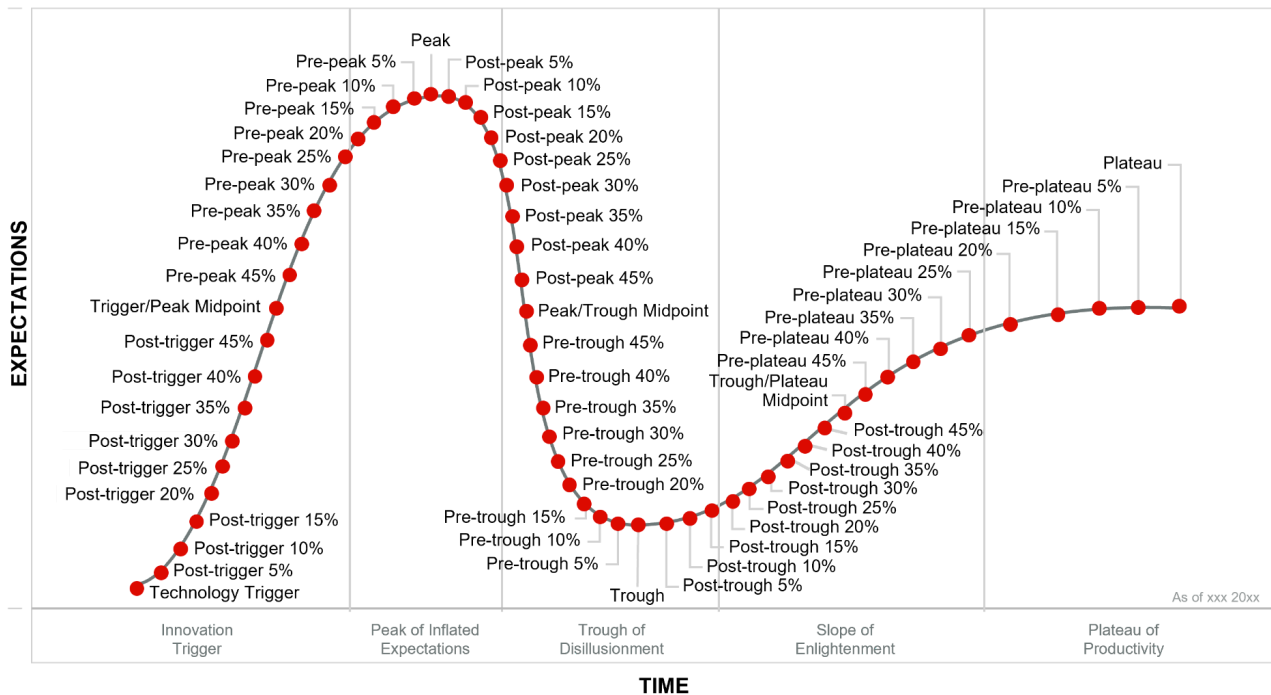
Two graphics are required: the Hype Cycle and the Priority Matrix. Three informational tables (Hype Cycle Phases, Benefit Ratings and Maturity Levels) are included in the Hype Cycle Appendix. The previous year’s Hype Cycle, if applicable, is shown as a link in the Appendix at the end of the report. **No other tables or figures are permitted.** Hype Cycle and Priority Matrix graphics are produced and managed within the CPP workspace.

Hype Cycle

Figure 1 shows the structure of the Hype Cycle and Innovation Profile placement points.

Figure 1. Hype Cycle Structure

The Hype Cycle



See the [Appendix](#) for examples of completed Hype Cycle and Priority Matrix figures.

The following table provides guidelines for Innovation Profile placement.

Table 1. Innovation Profile Placement Guidelines

Hype Cycle Section	HC range	Maturity Level	Years to Mainstream Adoption	Market Penetration as % of target audience
On the Rise	Trigger to Pre-peak 25%	Embryonic or Emerging	More than 10 years or Five to 10 years	Less than 1% of target audience or 1% to 5% of target audience
At the Peak	Pre-peak 20% to Post-peak 20%	Emerging or Adolescent	More than 10 years, or Five to 10 years, or Two to Five to years	1% to 5% of target audience or 5% to 20% of target audience

Hype Cycle

Sliding into the Trough	Post-peak 25% to Post-trough 15%	Emerging or Adolescent	Five to 10 years, or Two to Five years, or Less than two years	1% to 5% of target audience or 5% to 20% of target audience
Climbing the Slope	Post-trough 20% to Pre-Plateau 25%	Adolescent or Early Mainstream	Two to Five years or Less than two years	5% to 20% of target audience or 20% to 50% of target audience
Entering the Plateau	Pre-Plateau 20% to Plateau	Early Mainstream or Mature Mainstream (rarely used)	Less than two years	20% to 50% of target audience or More than 50% of target audience (rarely used)

The Hype Cycle and the Priority Matrix graphics are generated from the data entered in the Innovation Profiles linked to the Hype Cycle report. Authors can view the in-progress Hype Cycle graphic and fine-tune Innovation Profile and labeling positions from within the Hype Cycle Workspace in CPP. During the content production process, editors will coordinate any revision of graphics with authors and designers as needed and finalize the graphics for publication.

Innovation Profiles

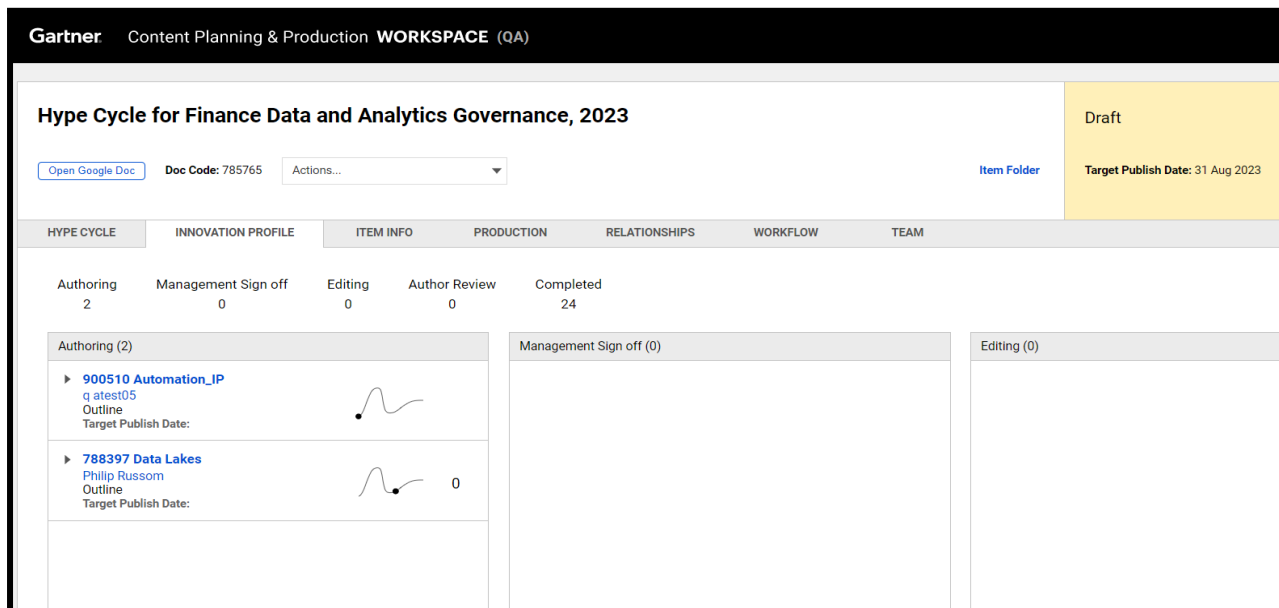
[Innovation Profiles](#) are the individual technologies, business disciplines or services that appear on a Hype Cycle. They are authored and edited separately in CPP, and completed prior to or in tandem with the authoring of the Hype Cycle. Any edits to Innovation Profiles must be done within the Innovation Profile file itself.

Authors add each Innovation Profile to their Hype Cycle. These Innovation Profile components comprise the majority of the Hype Cycle report text; they are building blocks of the Hype Cycle report. Completed Innovation Profiles may be components of more than one Hype Cycle. Innovation Profiles also may be contextualized for use in other Hype Cycles. For graphic clarity, no more than 35 Innovation Profiles should appear in a Hype Cycle. **The ideal number is 25.**

Hype Cycle authors can manage Innovation Profiles from within the Hype Cycle Workspace in CPP.

Hype Cycle

Figure 2. CPP Workspace View - Innovation Profile Tab



Use the Innovation Profile tab to view the status of the Innovation Profiles in a Hype Cycle. Use the Hype Cycle tab to add, delete and manage individual Innovation Profiles and refine the Hype Cycle graphic.

Please refer to the [Innovation Profile guidelines](#) for detailed guidance on creating and editing Innovation Profiles.

Hype Cycle Report Content

The sections for each Hype Cycle report are Summary, What You Need to Know, Hype Cycle Introduction, Priority Matrix Introduction, and Recommended Reading. Off the Hype Cycle is optional, but strongly encouraged. Strategic Planning Assumptions are optional.

- **Summary:** The Summary is a short section (300 characters maximum, including spaces) that appears with the title in search/browse on gartner.com. It is usually 1-3 sentences describing the Hype Cycle's area or market, noting the target role and outlining how they can use the Hype Cycle. The number of innovations appearing on the Hype Cycle may also be mentioned.
- **What You Need to Know:** This is a concise section (150 words, maximum) providing top-level, overall conclusions and recommendations for the target role.
- **Hype Cycle Introduction:** This section should be no more than 300 words. Describe the relevant market or area for this Hype Cycle, how it is changing and how the changes are reflected in the Hype Cycle itself. The Introduction includes:
 - o A description of any unusual attribute(s) of the Hype Cycle graphic, such as empty or crowded areas.
 - o A discussion of notable changes since last year's Hype Cycle, including new entrants, fast movers, those with slower-than-expected progress, highly hyped or undervalued entries, and any that have moved backward (this is rare, but must be explained if it does happen).
 - o Technologies or innovations featured on the prior year's Hype Cycle that have been dropped should also be mentioned here.
 - o A reference to the Hype Cycle figure. The Introduction will appear before the Hype Cycle graphic in the Analysis section of the report.

Hype Cycle

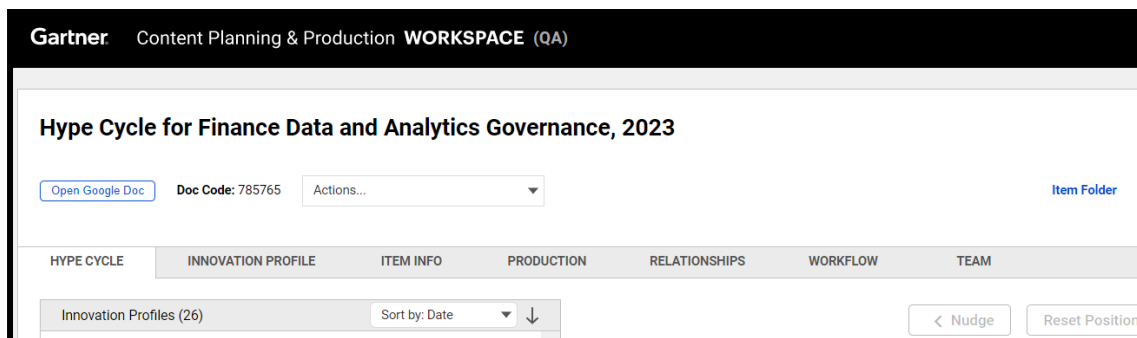
Do not use Hype Cycle curve positions in text; external readers won't understand what they mean. For example, a reference to "post-trigger 10%" could be rephrased as "new to the market."

- **Priority Matrix Introduction:** Discuss the potential benefit of the Innovation Profile entries on the overall market or area covered in a particular Hype Cycle. Be sure the benefits of the technologies/services (i.e., the Innovation Profiles) are spread over the "benefit" axis of the Priority Matrix, or explain why the pattern is uneven. Call out the impact of transformative and/or high-impact technologies likely to mature during the next two years, and describe how your target audience can leverage these technologies to gain competitive advantage. The recommended length limit is 200 words.
- **Off the Hype Cycle:** List any Innovation Profiles that appeared in the previous Hype Cycle but were removed this year. Create a brief bullet point for each one (limit 100 words per technology), stating the reason for its removal (e.g., fully mature, name changed to xxx, moved to Hype Cycle Y this year, subsumed by xyz), and any resulting recommended actions. If no Innovation Profiles were removed, delete this section.
- **Recommended Reading:** List up to 10 selections of relevant Gartner research, including the latest version of "[Understanding Gartner's Hype Cycles](#)" and "[Create Your Own Hype Cycle With Gartner's Hype Cycle Builder](#)".

Working With Hype Cycles in Workspace

The CPP Workspace is where you will manage each Hype Cycle. The Workspace includes the following sections:

Figure 6: CPP Hype Cycle Workspace



Hype Cycle: The section displays all the Innovation Profiles used in the Hype Cycle and the interactive Hype Cycle graphic. From this section, you can add or remove Innovation Profiles, and edit the Hype Cycle graphic.

Innovation Profile: This section shows the status of all the Innovation Profiles used in the Hype Cycle.

Item Info: This section shows the Hype Cycle metadata, including Role, Core Topics and Client Questions.

Relationships: This section shows UNIs, Contextualizations, Companions, Report Highlights, Research Collections and Translations associated with the Hype Cycle.

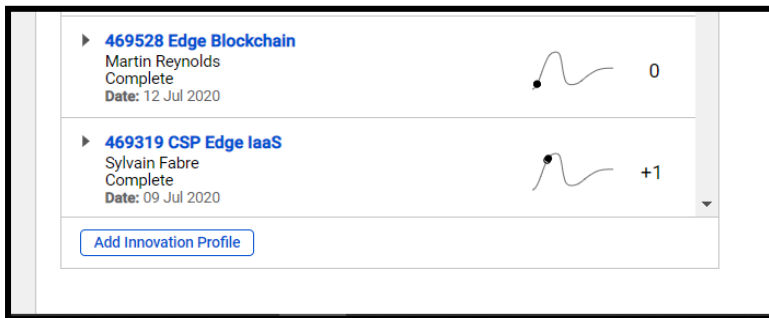
Workflow: This section shows the status of the document in the content production process.

Activities

Adding an Innovation Profile: To add an Innovation Profile to a Hype Cycle, go to the Hype Cycle tab. Click the "Add Innovation Profile" button in the lower left corner.

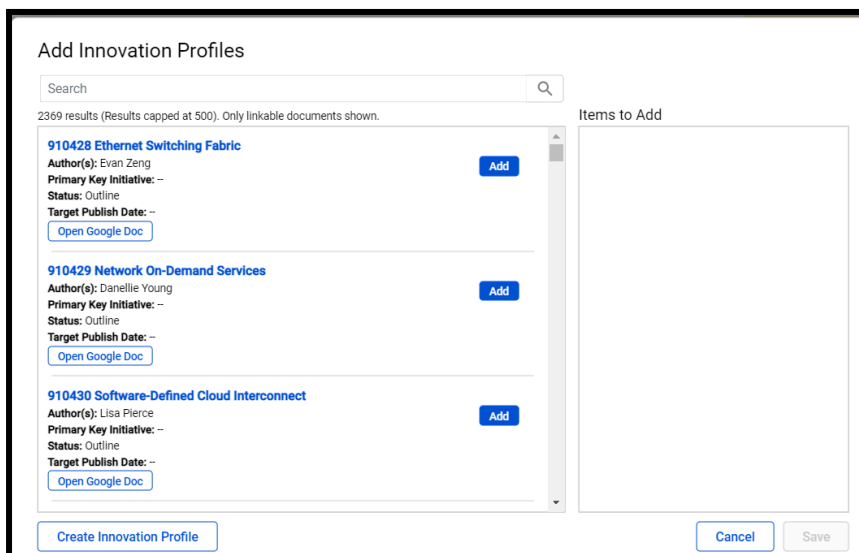
Hype Cycle

Figure 7: Add Innovation Profile to Hype Cycle



From the menu that appears, you can search for Innovation Profiles to add to the Hype Cycle, or create a new Innovation Profile.

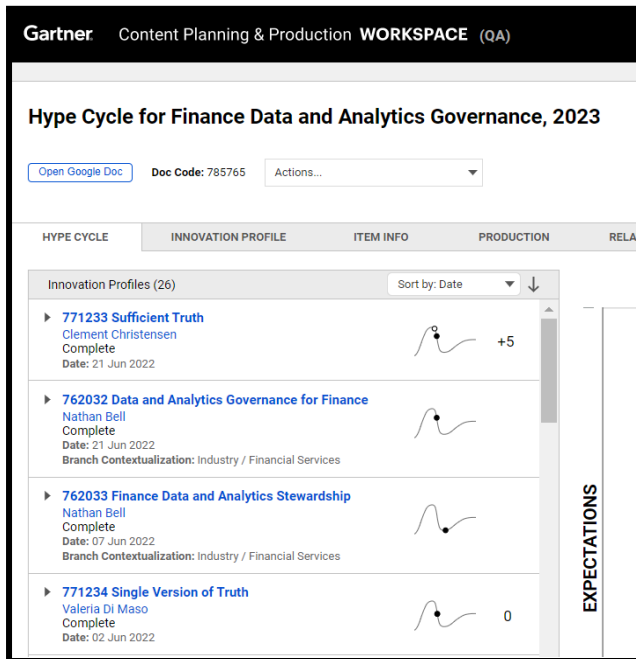
Figure 8: Add Innovation Profiles menu



Deleting an Innovation Profile: To delete an Innovation Profile, highlight the Innovation Profile you wish to delete, and then click the trash can that appears.

Hype Cycle

Figure 9: Deleting an Innovation Profile

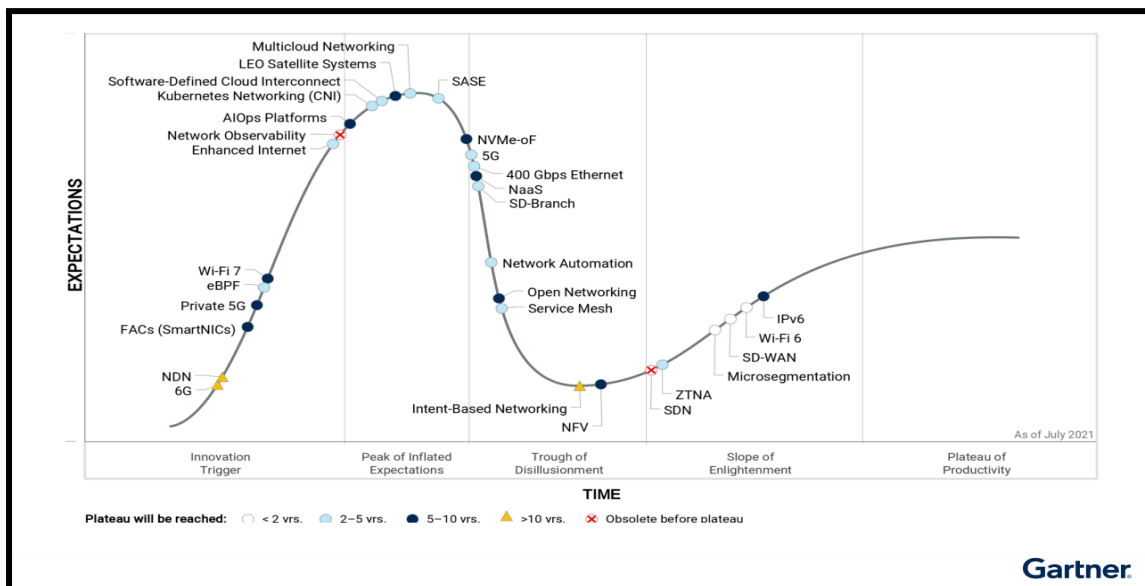


Editing the Hype Cycle Graphic: The interactive Hype Cycle Graphic tool in the workspace provides the ability to edit the Hype Cycle graphic in real time.

When working with a Hype Cycle graphic from a UNI'd Hype Cycle, the graphic will initially be somewhat disorganized. Do not be alarmed.

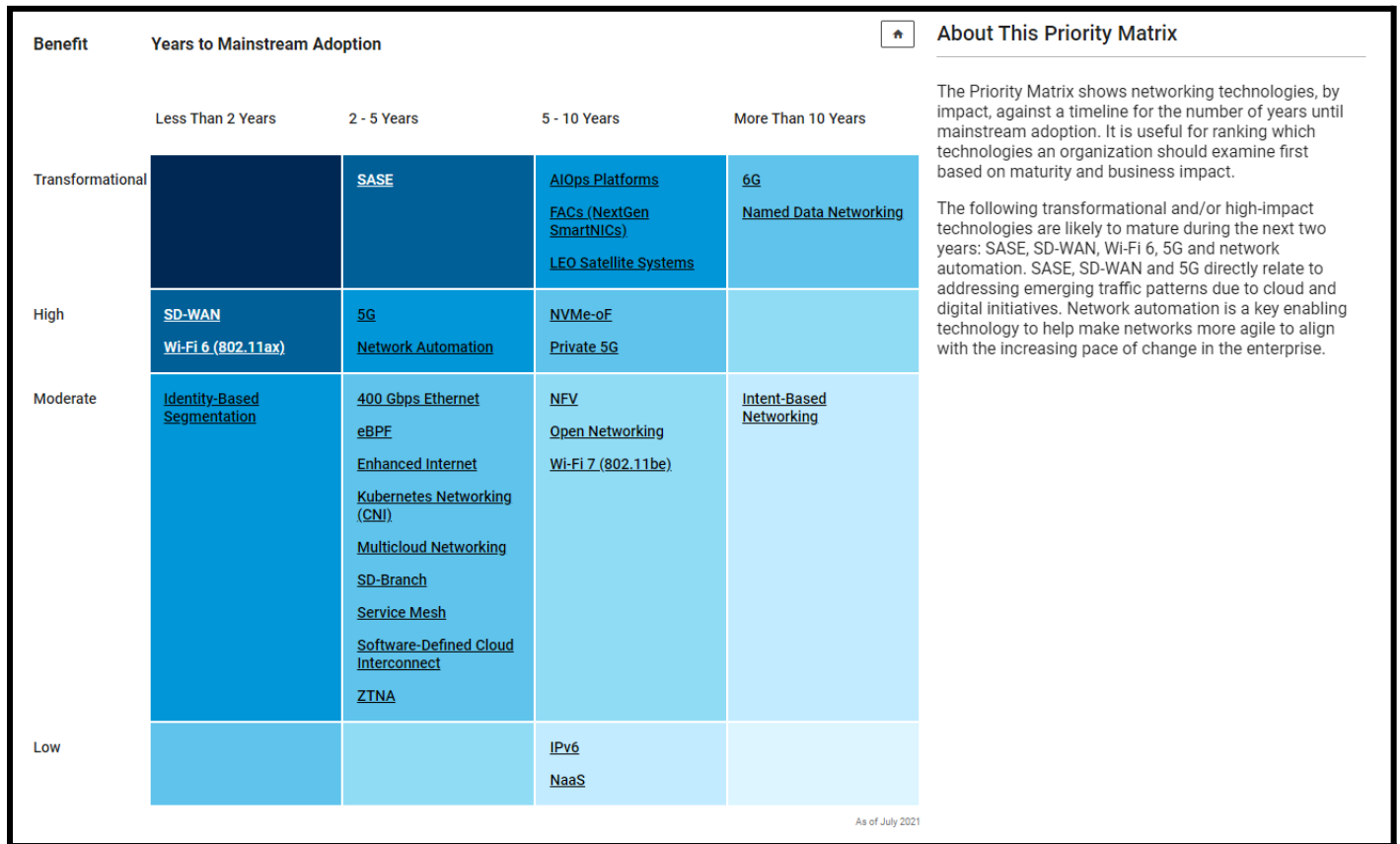
Appendix

Figure 11. Example: Completed Hype Cycle



Hype Cycle

Figure 12. Example: Priority Matrix



Additional Resources

Resource	Description
Content Essentials	Content Essentials is a set of seven criteria identified through client feedback that support quality content and strengthen client retention.
How to Write Good Titles, Summaries and Executive Summaries How to Write a Great Summary	Detailed instructions on how to write good titles, summaries, and executive summaries.
Contextualization Availability by Content Type	Details the contextualization options available for each content type
Content Type Life Cycle Management Options	Details the lifecycle management options(default, extendable, evergreen, etc.) for all content types

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External Review Policy	This policy outlines general guidelines for when external review is required.
Gartner's Research Contribution & Attribution Guidelines	This document defines the Gartner associate roles involved in content creation and outlines their attribution on Gartner.com.
Content Help Center	Provided tips, tools and best practices for planning content before you begin.
AskMethodologies	AskMethodologies is a knowledge base that covers topics such as contextualization, policies and content lifecycle management, and it's the first place associates should go with any Methodologies-related questions.
Launchpad	Links to the Launchpad
Getting to Know Quick Answer	A video Tutorial that explains the content type, helpful tips, and things to avoid.
Is a Quick Answer Right for Me?	A helpful guide to determine if your question or NLQ should be addressed via a Quick Answer.

Document Update History

Month of Document Update	Notable Changes
December 2025	- Minor updates to reflect change from R&A to BTI - Examples refreshed
November 2024	The Recommended Reading section has been moved from the canvas into an Add-On panel. See this page and this user guide for reference.
August 2023	The Key Facts Sidebar has been edited to remove the practices and any superfluous text, and to add links to the Content Type Life Cycle Management Options and the Content Help Center.
March 2023	Examples updated
September 2021	Examples and sample graphics updated
March 2021	Guidelines moved to Google Docs and updated to reflect content type's transition to CPP
April 2021	Updates to reflect addition of Hype Cycle Graphic tool to CPP Workspace

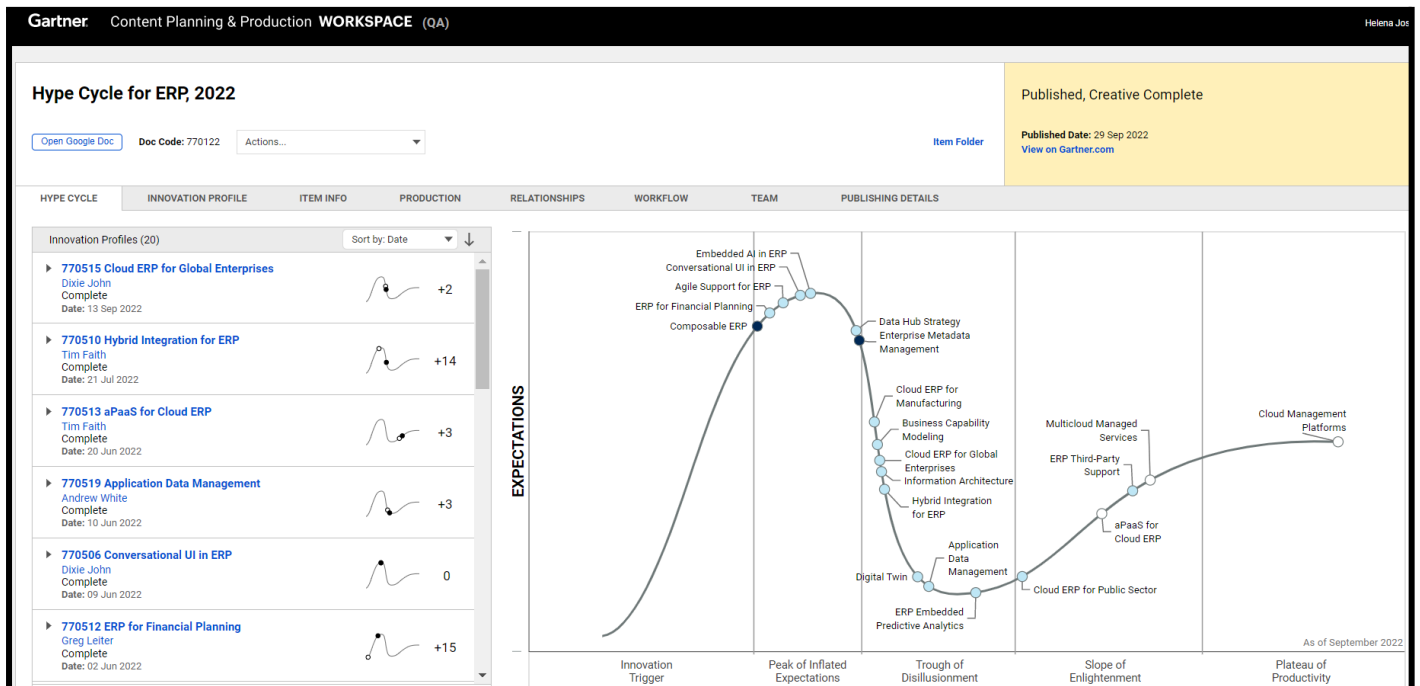
Hype Cycle

APPENDIX NOTES

Work through the graphic using the following steps:

If you need a better view of the Hype Cycle graphic while you are authoring, you can make simple edits to the positions of the labels and dots (note that the metadata attached to each IP will not change based on any edits to the HC graphic).

Figure 10: Unedited Hype Cycle Graphic



- Click on a label to move it. Move the labels across the graphic so they can be read clearly.
- Once the labels are separated and clearly visible, determine if any dots are obscuring each other. You may need to move the dots slightly so that readers can see both their placement and their color. Use the “Nudge” function to move the dots and create just enough separation between them to differentiate. Use the “Reset” button to return a dot to its original position.
- When the dots are separated and clearly visible, return to the labels and organize their presentation.
- As a general rule, the Peak and the Trough should always have IPs in them. Having the Peak and the Trough empty may indicate unwillingness to take a position.
- There are some exceptions, such as the Emerging Technologies HC, which only has technologies up to the Peak. Check that the position of each IP is consistent with its maturity level, time to plateau, and market penetration. Exceptions and unusual situations should be explained in the IP and the HC introduction.
 - Refer to the HC quality checklist linked below for a cross-check guide.